

Power Tips For for Using Primary Storage

How Much Space Is Enough?

Depending on your computing needs, users can be classified into the following types:

Less is good...

...if your time on the PC is spent surfing the Internet and maybe creating a spreadsheet or two. A hard disk with the bare minimum capacity should be enough for you. The same holds true for businesses where the PC is primarily used for accounting and billing purposes, or for creating letters and spreadsheets. A 40 GB drive should be sufficient, that's the entry-level solution available today. Given your frugal need for space, this hard disk should last you several years.

Size does matter...

...if you're a typical home user who stores the latest applications, MP3s, videos, movie trailers and even full-length movies, not to mention space-hogging games. No amount of space is ever going to satisfy you. Go for at least a 60 GB drive. If you feel you might exceed that as well, 80 GB might be more appropriate. Space also matters if you use CAD/CAM software, or are a graphics professional with a penchant for 3D animations.

Speed is your mantra...

...if you are a power user, but lack the purchasing power to buy a SCSI drive. Consider a 7200 rpm drive—the capacity you get would depend on how much you can afford, but an 80 GB drive should suit you just fine.

5 Tips to Keep your Drive Shipshape

- Protect the drive from shocks and jerks.
- Always handle the drive by its side. Never touch the underside of the drive or the drive electronics.
- When installing the hard drive, take care to screw it firmly to the chassis of the computer to protect it from vibrations when using the PC. The maximum damage that a drive suffers is usually due to improper handling during installation.



Also make sure the screws that come with the hard drive match the bore size on the drive.

■ Never try to open a hard disk if it fails to respond. Even a particle of dust entering the insides of the drive can destroy the platter on the disk.

■ Enable S.M.A.R.T. from the BIOS. This slows the drive down, but the difference is hardly noticeable for most applications - only 2-5 per cent. S.M.A.R.T. is a technology that warns you when there's a problem and the drive is about to fail.

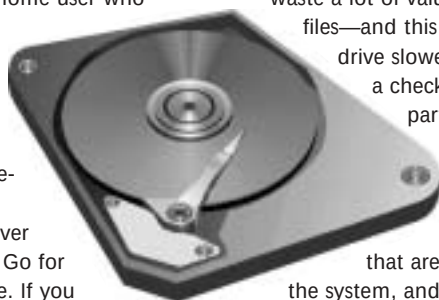
Tip For Organising Files And Folders

As you install more programs, the number of files and folder naturally increases. If you're not properly organised, you will waste a lot of valuable time searching for files—and this also makes the hard drive slower. The best way to keep a check on this is by partitioning the hard drive and allocating each partition a size according to the number of applications that are going to be installed on the system, and the amount of data that will be stored.

Here are some simple tips.

- Always store files and folders on the secondary partition.
- Name the folder according to the data being stored in it—such as 'Accounts' for files relating to accounts.
- Name the files in such a way that it carries enough information regarding its content, date it was generated and the name of the concerned person.
- Keep separate folders for different kind of files, such as images, spreadsheets, text documents and so on.
- Try not to install games, application and other system utilities on this partition as it will clutter the disk with other kind of data and slow down disk access.

Over a period of time, as a lot of data is stored and deleted it becomes imperative to defragment the data, which essentially means rearranging the data at one place so that access becomes faster. Windows itself provides you this utility, so you need not bother installing a third-party



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